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No.F 12783/2027/23.

His Majesty's Principal Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs presents his compliments to His Excellency the Chinese Ambassador and has the honour to refer to his note F.O.46/206 of the 31st August on the subject of the status of Formosans.

2. His Majesty's Government in the United Kingdon continue to adhere to the Cairo Declaration of the 1st December, 1943, regarding the restoration to China of the island of Formosa. This Declaration of Allied purpose however could not of itself transfer sovereignty over Formosa from Japan to China, which must await the conclusion of a peace treaty with Japan or the execution of some other formal diplomatic instrument. This being so, Mr. Bevin regrets that he cannot agree that Formosans have yet re-acquired Chinese nationality, even though Formosa itself is not under the administration of the Chinese Government. In the meantime, pending some formal act such as that referred to above, instructions have been sent to the British territories concerned that Formosans should in general be treated as nationals of a friendly country.

FOREIGN OFFICE, S.W.1.

26th September, 1946.